Open-source repository launch: verify install, release and contribution paths

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Verify the path from README to first result

Start with a clear one-line description, a short demo, a verified install path, a runnable sample, and the repository license. Test installation in a clean environment and record the required version, permissions, and expected output. Let a new user follow the README without relying on a maintainer's shell configuration. A hosted demo helps when users can reach the useful result directly.

Prepare the repository for discovery and support

GitHub documents a maximum of 20 topics. Each is at most 50 characters and uses lowercase letters, numbers, and hyphens. Use relevant search terms. The social preview should be under 1 MB and at least 640 by 320 pixels. GitHub recommends 1280 by 640 pixels for best display. Add a contribution guide, structured issue intake, a security reporting path, and scoped first issues. Enable Discussions when maintainers can support it. GitHub topics (https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/managing-your-repositorys-settings-and-features/customizing-your-repository/classifying-your-repository-with-topics) - Preview settings (https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/managing-your-repositorys-settings-and-features/customizing-your-repository/customizing-your-repositorys-social-media-preview) - Community files (https://docs.github.com/en/communities/setting-up-your-project-for-healthy-contributions/creating-a-default-community-health-file)

Gate the release

- Require passing CI for the exact release commit. Tag it and explain changes, upgrade requirements, and known failures.
- Review the package contents and history for secret exposure. If a credential is exposed, revoke or rotate it first. Coordinate any necessary history rewrite, including downstream copies and branch protection, through the incident owner. GitHub sensitive data guidance (https://docs.github.com/en/authentication/keeping-your-account-and-data-secure/removing-sensitive-data-from-a-repository)
- Publish to Show HN when readers can try the project. Follow its title and participation rules and let interest develop without soliciting votes. Set a support response target the team can sustain. The reel's one-day target and popularity claims lack a demonstrated causal estimate. Show HN guidelines (https://news.ycombinator.com/showhn.html)

Practice project

Use the launch evidence template on a disposable repository. Add screenshots or logs for fresh installation, CI, a sample result, and the release tag. Give each issue an owner and a retest condition.

Read-only preflight

```
git status --short
git log -1 --oneline
git tag --list
```

Reusable prompt

```
Audit this repository for a first public release. For each checklist item report evidence, a reproduction step, and any blocking decision. Verify clean install and a first useful result. Draft suggested changes separately from external actions. Flag any exposure for credential rotation and a reviewed incident plan. Leave publishing and history changes outside the audit.
```

Original sources

- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DfOKI7NFSWr/